Impartial Analysis of Measure J

Pursuant to Education Code section 35767, the Monterey County Superintendent of Schools ordered this measure to be placed on the ballot, which reorganizes South Monterey County Joint Union High School District (SMCJUHSD) to form a new unified school district covering the territory of Greenfield Union School District to be known as Greenfield Unified School District, and a second unified school district covering the rest of the territory of SMCJUHSD to be known as King City Joint Unified School District, resulting in the dissolution of Greenfield Union School District, King City Union School District and SMCJUHSD. Any qualified voter who resides within the boundaries of SMCJUHSD may vote on the measure.

At its regular meeting on July 8, 2026, the California State Board of Education held a public hearing and after the public hearing approved the Plans and Recommendations for the reorganization as set forth above. Further, the Plans and Recommendations also approved the individual requests of the San Lucas Union Elementary School District, San Ardo Union Elementary School District, Bradley Union Elementary School District, San Antonio Union Elementary School District and Bitterwater-Tully Elementary School District to be component districts of the new King City Joint Unified School District pursuant to Educations Code section 35542(b).

On July 9, 2026, California State Board of Education provided notice of approval of the Plans and Recommendation to the Monterey County Superintendent of Schools pursuant to Education Code section 35755. This measure also seeks to consolidate the election for the purpose of electing the governing board of the unified school district proposed to be formed, with the election held, for adopting, or rejecting, the Plans and Recommendation for the formation of the new school district.

Therefore, the governing boards for the proposed new school districts will be placed on the ballot and if the measure passes, then the governing board election will already have occurred, and the board will be ready to govern. If this measure does not pass, the existing school boards will remain in place and any existing elections for seats on the existing board may also take place, so that the existing board can continue to govern.

A "Yes" vote on this measure is a vote in favor of the reorganization of the South Monterey County Joint Unified High School District (SMCJUHSD) into two districts, to be known as the Greenfield Unified District, and the King City Joint Unified School District. Greenfield Union School District, King City Union School District and SMCJUHSD would be dissolved.

A "No" vote on this measure is a vote against the reorganization of the South Monterey County Joint Unified High School District (SMCJUHSD) into two districts, such that Greenfield Union School District, King City Union School District and SMCJUHSD would remain.

Dated: August 13, 2026

Susan Blitch
County Counsel,
County of Monterey